

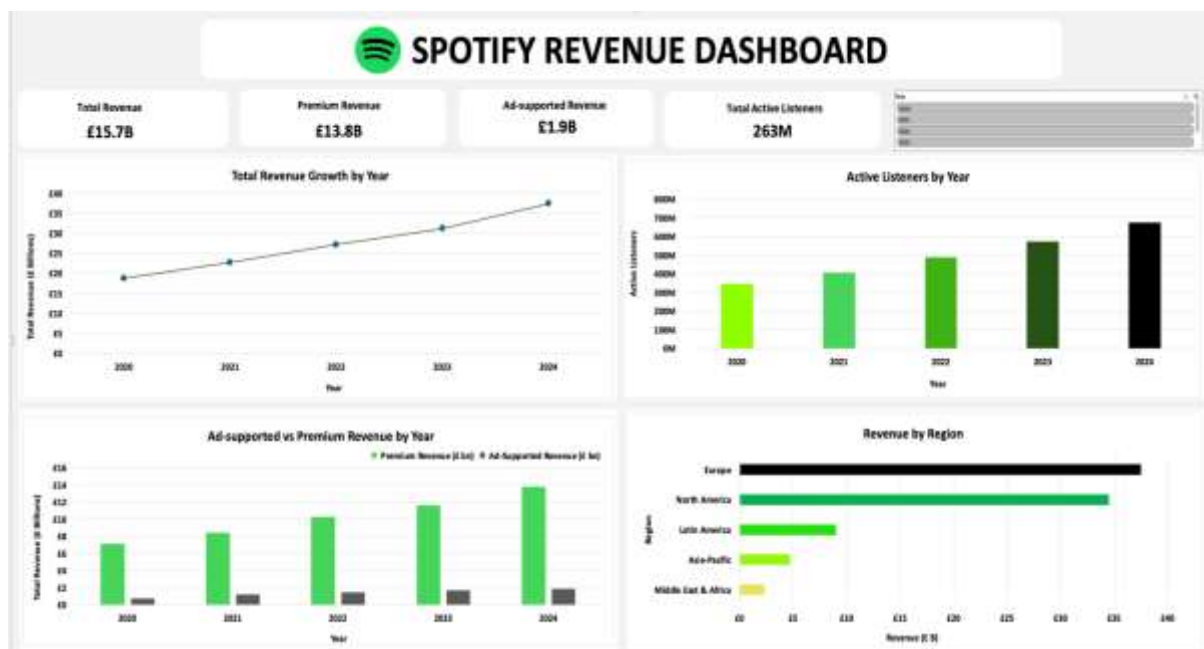
Dashboard Design: Spotify

Introduction

Spotify is an music streaming service that provides its users access to music, podcasts and audiobooks. Spotify operates in a competitive digital market where it is critical to identify user growth, engagement and monetisation potential for long-term success. The dashboard has been designed to align with Spotify's business objectives of scaling audience reach and driving recurring revenue. The dashboard provides a single and trusted view of insights to aid strategic business decision making. The dashboard has been created primary for C-Suite level management (Chief Executive Officer, Chief Financial Officer, Chief Revenue Officer) and financial teams who require a high-level, holistic view of the monetisation potential, monthly active users and business growth over the years. The data is collected from Spotify's annual financial report for five years (2020-2024).

Dashboard Design

The dashboard was created using Microsoft Excel, the tool was chosen to support the creation of the interactive dashboard, displaying key performance indicators and metrics supporting decision making. The layout applies Moriarty's principle of using a grid system and maintaining consistency, simplicity, clarity and creating a clear dashboard design. Geckoboard's rules on the glanceability of a dashboard informed the use of consistent colours and concise labels for data storytelling (Moriarty, n.d.; Geckoboard, n.d.; Geckoboard, 2020).



Dashboard Layout & Visual Components

1. Executive Summary KPIs

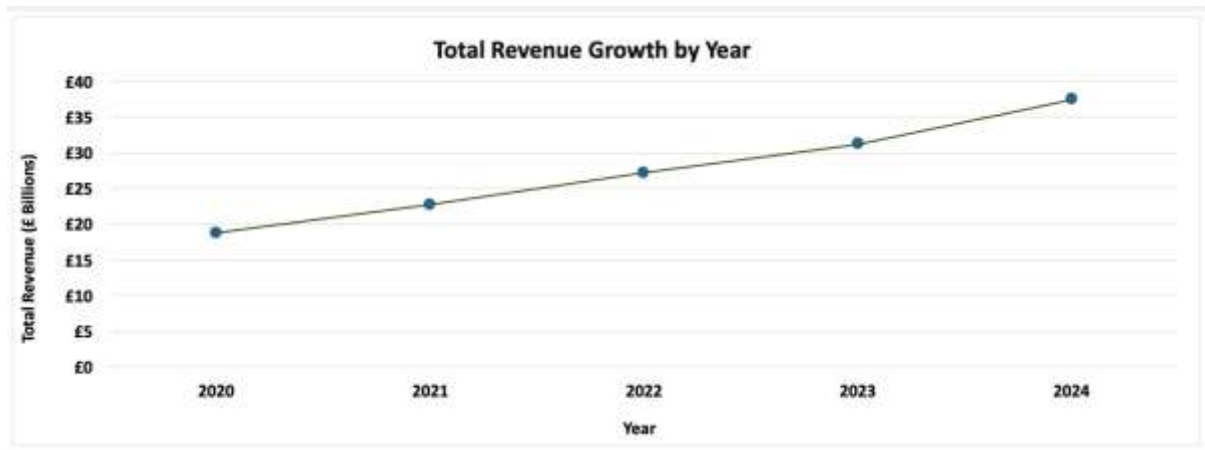
This provides a high-level overview of Spotify's core performance metrics. At the top of the dashboard, the four most critical performance indicators for Spotify is displayed for easy identification. This gives an executive everything they need to know at a glance and to identify important business metrics such as the company growth (Total Active Listeners), monetising that growth (Revenue) and doing so through a valuable subscriber base (Premium Revenue) and (Ad-supported Revenue).

- I. **Total Revenue:** This is the total income the business earned from its services.
- II. **Premium Revenue:** This is the revenue generated from premium subscribers on the platform, it is Spotify's major revenue generator.
- III. **Ad-supported Revenue:** This is the revenue generated from ad-supported tier, demonstrating Spotify's ability to monetise non-paying users. It is Spotify's second revenue generator.
- IV. **Total Active Listeners:** This is the total number of active listeners on Spotify.

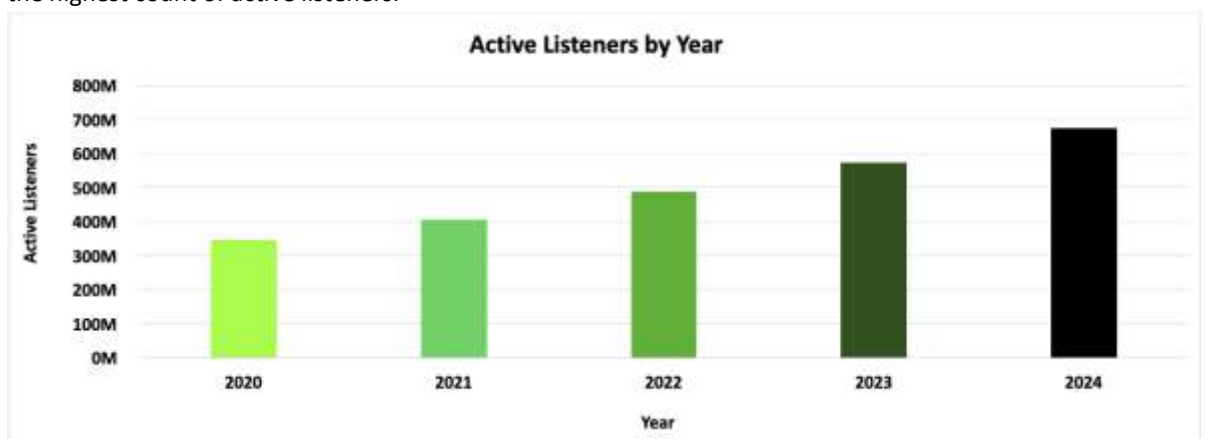
2. Business Growth

The second layer of the dashboard clearly identifies the growth of the business, in terms of Total Revenue Growth by Year and Active Listeners by Year.

I. Total Revenue Growth by Year (Line Chart): The visualisation was selected because line charts easily highlight trends over time. The consistent upward trajectory conveys a compelling top-line growth story for investors and the C-Suite. The revenue was plotted against the year 2020 to 2024, with the unit in Billions and B used to represent this scale.



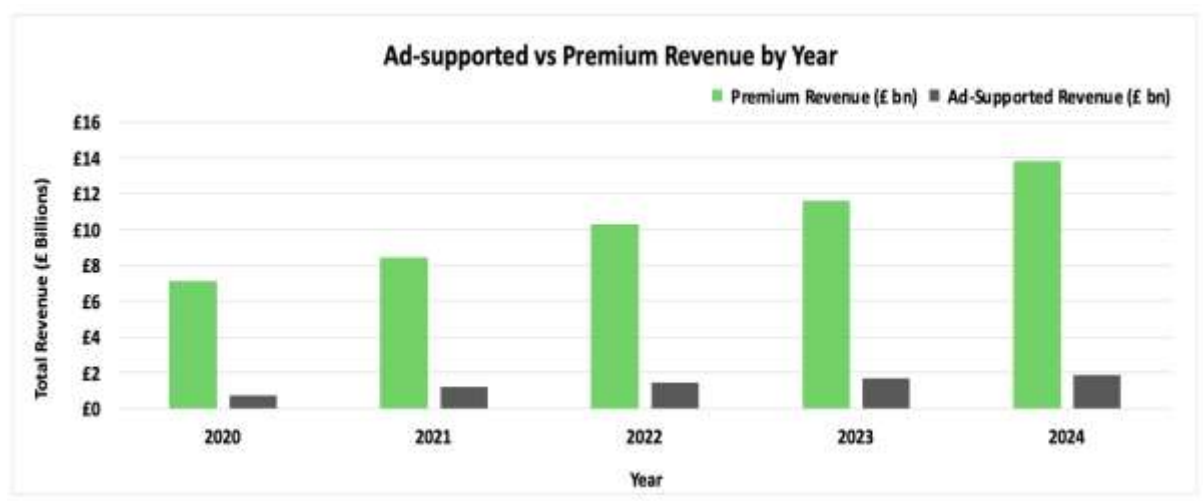
II. Active Listeners by Year (Bar Chart): This highlights the growth of the business in terms of active listener count over five years (2020-2024). The visualisation was selected because bar charts are best suited for comparing categories in this case the categories. The data is in Millions with M used to represent this scale, from the dashboard the active listeners have increased steadily over the course of the years with 2024 representing the highest count of active listeners.



3. Revenue Contributors

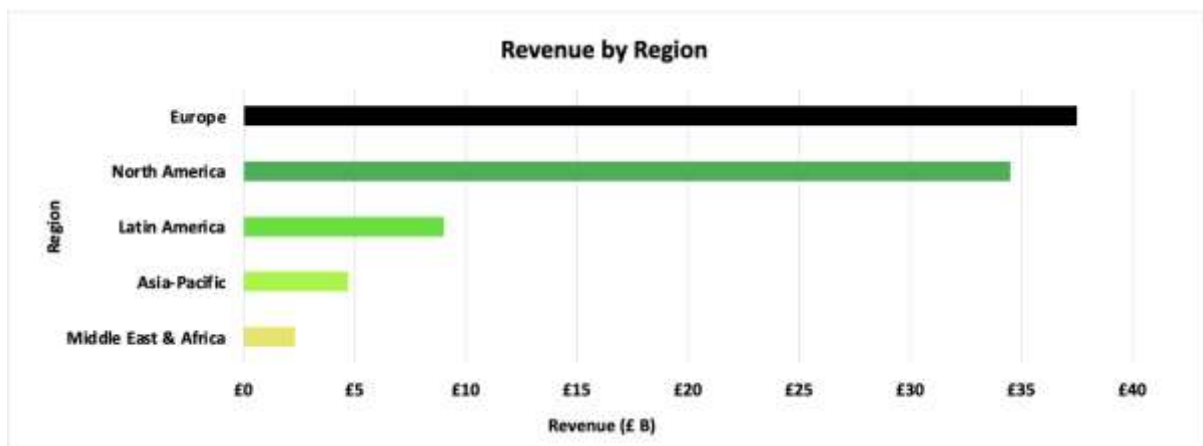
The final layer of the dashboard provides a diagnostic breakdown of Spotify's performance, focusing on revenue sources and geographic distribution.

I. Ad-supported vs Premium Revenue by Year (Clustered Column Chart): The visualisation was selected because a clustered column chart makes it easy to distinguish between Spotify's key revenue drivers - Premium subscribers and Ad-supported subscribers (non-paying users) over the years 2020 to 2024. Premium revenue contributes the majority of revenue generated in Spotify, while ad-supported revenue shows steady year-on-year growth, reflecting to Spotify executives an opportunity that can be explored to generate more revenue.



II. Revenue by Region (Horizontal Bar Chart)

A **horizontal bar chart** is ideal for ranking categories with longer labels (e.g., “Middle East & Africa”). The chart displays revenue generated from each region with Europe being the largest revenue generator for Spotify. This enables Spotify's executives to identify what regions the revenue is most concentrated and where untapped potential exists.



Metrics Selection

A critical synthesis of Geckoboard's (n.d.; 2020) emphasis on glanceable, decision-oriented visualisation and Moriarty's (n.d.) principles for good dashboard design, which emphasise clarity, relevance, and contextual knowledge, informs the choice of metrics, thereby supporting strategic decision-making at every level. The metrics for the dashboard are below:

1. Total Revenue – This is the total sum of all revenue generated from Premium and Advertising Revenue. This serves as the primary measurement of commercial impact.

Design Rationale: The integration of year-over-year percentage changes provides immediate momentum context, transforming static financial figures into dynamic performance indicators.

2. Active Listeners - This is the number of unique users engaging yearly. This quantifies the total platform reach and ecosystem scale that serves as the foundation for both subscription conversions and advertising inventory.

Design Rationale: Presenting both absolute scale and growth rate enables executives to assess market penetration and expansion velocity simultaneously.

4. Revenue by Region – This is the geographical distribution of total revenue. This provides intelligence on market maturity, concentration risks and expansion opportunities across global operations.

Design Rationale: Integration through choropleth map visualisation enables instant spatial analysis of the global footprint and strategic market positioning.

5. Premium & Ad-Supported Revenue - Breakdown of revenue streams

This shows business model mix and strategic dependencies between the two primary monetisation engines.

Design Rationale: Separate visualisation prevents total revenue figures from masking critical shifts in revenue composition.

Points considered to build the dashboard

1. Decision Linkage to Executive Actions (Audience)

Each metric was selected based on its ability to directly inform specific strategic decisions and answer key executive questions. The audience of the dashboard being top level executives was identified. This approach ensures the dashboard functions as an active decision-support tool.

2. Prioritisation of the most important data

Across the dashboard, only the metrics related to the purpose of driving revenue were included in the design.

3. Rounded Numbers

All the Spotify values are in millions and billions, however the data was rounded to 0-1 decimal places for the design of the dashboard, to support a clear decision making.

4. Selection of effective visualisations

The visualisations were chosen based on the data type, the accuracy and ease of representing the data to the dashboard user.

5. Grouping of related metrics

The dashboard was designed thoughtfully, with related metrics grouped together.

6. Hierarchy

Important metrics are in bigger fonts to highlight their importance. Additionally, in building the dashboard the important information was placed on the top left for immediate identification.

7. Use of clear labels

The charts have chart titles, with the axis labelled accurately for a professional dashboard design.

Conclusion

The Business Intelligence Systems course introduced our group to understanding of how data can be converted into useful insights through visualisation and a thoughtful design. Applying principles from Moriarty and Geckoboard reinforced the value of simplicity, relevance, and storytelling in dashboard design.

References

Moriarty, T. (n.d.) *10 Principles for Building Effective Dashboards*. [online] Geckoboard. Available at: <https://www.geckoboard.com/learn/dashboard-design/10-principles-for-building-effective-dashboards/> (Accessed: 21 October 2025).

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